

pillar of Don Sal Marcano's empire one by one. Damaging Sal's businesses, and taking over his rackets makes sense, and does well to put the player in the forefront of the action.

The damaged businesses can be reassigned to one of the three underbosses serving you – the Irish underboss, Burke, the Italian underboss, Vito or the African American underboss Cassasndra. Each underboss offers a variety of different perks, and the player is needed to assess his requirements, and make for an informed decision. After taking over a territory, the player is required to assign the territory to an underboss. Each underboss tries to persuade the player into handing the territory over to him. This sense of power handed to the player is quite awesome. But ignore one underboss too much, and he turns on you, and sends his henchmen to assassinate you. The game's outcome is based on the decisions that you take throughout the game. This adds a dynamic touch.

Sound & Voice Acting

The characters of Mafia III have been ornamented by an amazing team of voice actors. Each remark is accompanied by conviction, and each character is empowered by their own perspective giving the game unparalleled diversification. Not limited to just the characters, the songs of Creedence Clearwater Revival, Jimi Hendrix or The Rolling Stones, every time you fire up the radio of a car, as also the background music of the game is a marvel in its own accord.

Graphics

Graphics is somewhere the game fails to make its mark. The game is riddled with glitches such as objects passing through walls. On countless occasions, while driving, I have seen sections of the environment further away being rendered, along with weird motion blur textures. The lighting and weather effects seem patchy and awkward. For a game that has been in the making for this long, the graphics seem incomplete and far from ready. This hampers the overall experience of the game.



MOAR

PUBLISHER - 2K Games

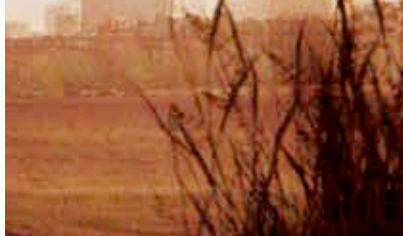
DESIGNER - Matthias Worch

DEVELOPERS: Hangar 13, 2K Czech, Mass Media Games

PLATFORMS: PlayStation 4, Xbox One, Microsoft Windows, macOS

PROS: Storyline, Vocal performances and character depth, close combat animations, thrilling boss missions.

CONS: Awkward lighting and weather effects, lack of character and weapon customizations, technical flaws such as cover and movement mechanisms, absence of vehicles other than cars, repetitive missions, lack of open world interactive elements



Gameplay

Even though the storyline is refreshing, throughout my 30 or so hours of playing the game, I found myself having mixed emotions. I thoroughly enjoyed the stealth kills, takedowns, assassinations, which seemed stunning the first time around. But owing to the game's repetitive nature, having to perform the same type of missions over and over again makes the game utterly boring. The absence of a Fast-Travel option adds to the set of troubles Mafia is already in. Several small duration missions need you to drive across the city, only to drive back again for a simple objective, which highlights the repetitive nature of the game.

Mafia essentially follows a standard-cover based shooting system. I found myself using Stealth kills more often than not. In this respect, the game's movie like animations do well to make close combat alluring. One of the more useful features which the game offers is allowing the player to buy weapons or deposit cash at any time by calling special-purpose cars from the in-game menu. These are unlocked as favors from the respective underbosses.

The game's overall appeal is tarnished by the dull AI which offers very little ingenuity and challenge. The exciting parts of the game lie solely in boss missions which are set in well-designed environments breathing new life to the monotony. New Bordeaux lacks vehicles such as motorcycles, bikes and trains. Other subtle elements such as the lack of aged pedestrians or youth, makes the game unrealistic to a certain point. The map is big, but there is almost nothing to do.

Verdict

Overall, Mafia presents a decent storyline and could have offered something truly immersive, but its flaws far outweigh its merits making the game which could have truly been remarkable, into something which is borderline average. Even though a comparison would be quite far-fetched, in my opinion, Mafia II released 6 years earlier felt like a more concrete package as compared to Mafia III. *